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National Pension System (NPS) Program Document

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Applicable to Deloitte USI*

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Introduction

The National Pension System (NPS) is a social security scheme introduced by the Government of India. NPS is a voluntary plan that enables employees to boost their retirement income and save on taxes. NPS acts as an additional retirement benefit alongside the Provident Fund (PF) and Gratuity.

Eligibility

Effective July 15, 2025, all USI full time employees (FTEs) are eligible to participate in National Pension System (NPS) program. This program is not offered to fixed term hires (FTHs) and interns/intern analysts.

Program Overview

NPS is a retirement savings initiative that aims to help employees build a secure financial future. Deloitte provides an opportunity to contribute voluntarily toward NPS and take advantage of benefits from systematic savings during their working years, ensuring financial stability in their later years. Additionally, NPS offers significant tax savings, making it an attractive option for employees looking to optimize their finances while preparing for retirement.

NPS Registration and Enrollment

The Deloitte USI NPS program is an excellent opportunity for employees to contribute toward building a secure retirement corpus while benefiting from the tax advantages. Interested employees who wish to take advantage of these benefits must complete the registration and enrollment processes to start contributing.

NPS Registration

- Definition: The registration process involves creating a new NPS account or transferring an existing NPS to the Deloitte USI NPS program.
- Each NPS account is associated with a unique Permanent Retirement Account Number (PRAN).
- Registration is a one-time process and can be completed anytime during the year.
- An eligible new hire can register to NPS when joining Deloitte USI.

NPS Enrollment

- **Definition:** The enrollment process is where employees can declare the percentage of their basic salary that they wish to contribute toward NPS.
- **Contribution options:**
    - Contribution Options: 5% or 10% or 14%
    - Tax benefits will be restricted up to 10% for the old tax regime.
- **Important:**
    - Enrollment can only be done bi-annually during the enrollment window in April and October. Employees already registered with the Deloitte USI NPS program can complete the enrollment process during these windows. New Hires can enroll in NPS at the time of their joining once they have completed the registration process. The enrollment window opens for the new hires and inclusion professionals (returning from onsite) between the 2nd to 18th of the month after their first payroll processed month. New hires are encouraged to complete the registration process (New PRAN generation/ Transfer of existing PRAN) before the enrollment window.
    - Only those employees who complete registration to Deloitte's NPS program and have a valid

PRAN will be allowed to define their contribution percentage during the NPS enrollment window. Employees who miss the opportunity to register before the enrollment window need to wait for the next window to define their contribution percentage and begin contributing.

- Any changes to the contribution percentage can be made only during the enrollment window. Once the window closes, changes to the contribution can be made in the next window.

NPS Contribution

Steps to declare contribution percentage

- To declare the contribution percentage, login to HR Workways and navigate to the NPS declaration form under My Transactions.
- Review your PRAN details and use the NPS Contribution % dropdown to select the percentage of Basic you would like to contribute toward NPS.
- The monthly contribution amount will be reflected in the NPS Contribution Amount field based on the contribution percentage selected under the NPS Contribution % dropdown.
- Once you have reviewed the Important Notes section, you can submit the NPS declaration form, and the contributions will begin from that month.

NPS Scheme Design

Under NPS, there are the following three primary intermediaries, amongst many others, responsible for managing and facilitating the contributions:

1. **Point of Presence (POP):** The POP is the service provider that helps employees get started with NPS. They assist in the registration process, manage account management, and support any queries or changes related to the NPS account.
2. **Central Recordkeeping Agency (CRA):** The CRA is responsible for maintaining NPS account information, keeping the account details up to date, and ensuring all contributions and transactions are accurately recorded.
3. **Pension Fund Manager (PFM):** The PFM is responsible for investing the NPS contributions to grow the retirement savings over time.

Deloitte has designated **ICICI Prudential Pension Fund Management Ltd.** as the PFM and the POP, and **KFin Technologies Ltd.** as the designated CRA. Under the Deloitte NPS program, asset allocation will follow the **Auto Choice** model with a **Moderate Life Cycle** fund investment option. Please refer to the table below to understand the asset allocation under the Moderate Life Cycle Fund investment option.

Age	Moderate Life Cycle Fund (LC 50)		
	Equity	Corporate Bonds	Government Securities
Up to 35 years	50%	30%	20%
40 years	40%	25%	35%
45 years	30%	20%	50%
50 years	20%	15%	65%
55 years	10%	10%	80%

! Employees who enroll in Deloitte's NPS (National Pension System) program will remain linked to the assigned Fund Manager, asset allocation, and investment options for the duration of their employment tenure with Deloitte, unless Deloitte opts to modify the Fund Manager, asset allocation, or investment options.

Tax Benefits

The tax benefits associated with NPS are governed by the Income Tax Act 1961 and the guidelines issued by the Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA).

Tax benefits for NPS investments are available under the following sections:

Applicable Sections under the Income Tax Act 1961	Tax Benefits
U/S 80CCD (2)	Up to 10% of the basic salary (14% if opted for New Tax Regime) contributed to NPS through the employer is tax-free. This is over and above the deduction of Rs. 1.5 lakh is available under section 80C and is only available for salaried employees.

Please Note

- Tax benefits under section 80 CCD (2) can be availed in either of the tax regimes.

Other Tax Benefits

NPS also offers tax benefits at the time of withdrawals or exit.

Scenario	Tax Benefit
Maturity	• On exit at maturity, employees can withdraw up to 80% of the corpus as a lump sum, out of which 60% will be tax-free. • The balance amount is also exempt from tax but needs to be invested in an annuity plan to receive a regular pension. However, the pension received from the investment in the annuity plan is treated as income and will be taxed.
Premature Exit	• On exit before the maturity term, employees can withdraw up to 20% of the corpus as a lump sum, tax-free. • Premature Exit is allowed only if employees have contributed to Corporate NPS for at least one year. • The balance amount is also exempt from tax but needs to be invested in an annuity plan to receive a regular pension. However, the pension received from the investment in the annuity plan is treated as income and will be taxed.
Withdrawal in case of death	• In case of the unfortunate death of the employee, the nominee can choose to either receive 100% of the pension wealth in a lump sum or purchase an annuity with accumulated pension wealth. • In case of lump-sum withdrawal, the entire amount is exempt from tax. • However, the pension received from investment in the annuity is treated as Income and will be taxed.

Process Steps

Registration Process

For employees without an existing NPS account

- Employees who do not have an NPS account need to register for Deloitte's NPS program and create one by following the steps outlined in the step-by-step guide.
- Once registered, an employee's NPS account is created, and a unique PRAN is allotted to the employee.

For employees with an existing NPS account

- Employees with an existing NPS account can transfer their account to Deloitte's NPS program by following the steps outlined in the step-by-step guide.
- Once transferred, the employee's NPS account and the associated PRAN will be mapped to Deloitte's NPS program.

Enrollment Process

The enrollment process can be completed on the payroll page, Excelity Global. To enroll, log in to the payroll page and follow the steps below. Before proceeding, ensure that you review the terms and conditions under the Important Notes section.

For New Hires

- Eligible employees will receive an email with details of the NPS registration and enrollment process when they join.
- Once registered, the employee's PRAN will be mapped to Deloitte's NPS program design.
- The NPS window will be open on HR Workways in the subsequent month after the first payroll is processed.
  Ex: If the first payroll is processed in January, then a window will open in February.
- Upon successful registration, employees can enroll in NPS by declaring the percentage of Basic they would like to contribute toward Corporate NPS (refer to the NPS Contribution setup section for steps to declare contribution percentage).
- The contributions will begin from the subsequent month's payroll.

For Existing Employees

- Eligible employees will receive communication regarding the enrollment window that is held bi-annually in April and October.
- Interested employees who have registered for Deloitte's NPS program and have their PRAN mapped to Deloitte's NPS program design can declare the percentage of Basic they would like to contribute toward NPS (refer to the NPS Contribution setup section for steps to declare contribution percentage).
- The contributions will begin after the enrollment window closure.

NPS Contribution Setup

Steps to declare contribution percentage

- To declare the contribution percentage, login to HR Workways and navigate to the NPS declaration form under My Transactions.
- Review your PRAN details and use the **NPS Contribution %** dropdown to select the percentage of Basic you would like to contribute toward NPS.

- The monthly contribution amount will be reflected in the **NPS Contribution Amount** field based on the contribution percentage selected under the **NPS Contribution %** dropdown.
- Once you have reviewed the Important Notes section, you can submit the NPS declaration form, and the contributions will begin from that month.

Steps to revise contribution percentage

- Employees can revise their contribution percentage during the enrollment window in April and October. Employees will be informed of the exact enrollment dates before the enrollment window is launched.
- To revise the percentage contribution toward NPS, login to HR Workways and navigate to the NPS declaration form under My Transactions.
- Use the **NPS Contribution %** dropdown to revise the contribution details.
- The revised contribution amount will be reflected in the **NPS Contribution Amount** field.
- You can submit the form once you have reviewed the Important Notes section, and the revised contributions will begin from that month.

Steps to opt-out of the NPS program

- Employees can opt out of NPS during the enrollment window in April and October.
- To stop contributing to Deloitte's NPS program, log in to HR Workways and navigate to the NPS declaration form under My Transactions.
- Select the check box **Stop NPS** and submit the form.
- All the fields will be greyed out, the contribution percentage will be set to 0%, and the contribution amount will be set to 0.
- Please note that if the minimum contribution of INR 1,000 for the year is not maintained, then the NPS account will freeze, and the employees will not be able to make any transactions to their NPS account.

Separation Process

Upon separation from the organization due to job change, retirement, or death, employees have several options regarding their NPS account. They can either choose to transfer the NPS account to the new employer's scheme or continue on an individual basis. Alternatively, they may choose to exit the scheme and withdraw the accumulated corpus or extend the contributions beyond retirement age if immediate withdrawal is not required. These options provide flexibility based on the employee's financial needs and future plans.

Separation due to Job Change

- When an employee decides to leave the organization, the contribution to Deloitte's NPS program will cease from the last working month of the employee.
- The NPS account remains active and fully portable, ensuring continuity of retirement savings.
- After separation, employees are advised to link their NPS account to the new employer, or they may choose to maintain contribution directly as an individual.
- Employees can also opt for a premature exit, where they can withdraw up to 20% of the accumulated corpus as a lump sum, and the remaining 80% can be utilized to buy an annuity plan and receive a regular monthly pension.
- Premature exit is allowed only if the employees have contributed to NPS for at least one year.

Separation with no job change (self-employment)

- The NPS account remains active and fully portable, ensuring continuity of retirement savings.

- The account is portable and not tied to any employer, and the employee can continue to make individual contributions to their account.
- Employees can also opt for a premature exit, where they can withdraw up to 20% of the accumulated corpus as a lump sum, and the remaining 80% can be utilized to buy an annuity plan and receive a regular monthly pension.
- Premature exit is allowed only if the employees have contributed to NPS for at least one year.

Separation due to Retirement

- **Upon reaching retirement age**
    - As mandated by the PFRDA, employees can withdraw a maximum of 80% of the accumulated pension wealth as a lump sum (out of which 60% will be tax free) at the time of retirement at the age.
    - The remaining corpus needs to be utilized for the purchase of an annuity plan to receive a regular monthly pension.
    - Employees have the option to extend their contributions beyond the retirement age. This extension can last up to 85 years. Such contribution can continue on an individual basis.
    - This option can help enhance the retirement corpus for those not requiring immediate withdrawals.

- **Early Retirement (before retirement age)**
    - Any withdrawal from the NPS account before attaining retirement age is treated as a premature exit.
    - Premature exit is allowed only if the employees have contributed to NPS for at least one year.
    - Employees can withdraw up to 20% of their accumulated pension wealth as a lump sum.
    - The remaining 80% of the corpus needs to be utilized for the purchase of an annuity plan to receive the regular pension.
    - Employees can defer the withdrawal until they reach retirement age or extend the contribution up to the age of 85 years.

Separation due to Death of Employee

- In the unfortunate event of the employee's death, the entire accumulated pension wealth (100%) would be paid to the nominee or legal heir.
- The nominee shall be as declared by the employee at the time of account opening.
- The Nominee of the deceased employee has the option to purchase any of the Annuity plans being offered upon exit.

Withdrawal/Exit Process

Employees can initiate request for withdrawal from Corporate NPS by contacting the POP team.

- **POP Email ID:** npsservice@iciciprupension.com
- All emails must be directed to the POP email ID mentioned above, with a copy to ICICI NPS RM Email ID given below.

Level	Name	Email DI	Mobile Number	Location
Level 1	Sampreeth Raghava	raghava.mandali@iciciprupension.com	7396111950	Hyderabad
Level 1	Anshul Garg	anshul.garg@iciciprupension.com	9914122963	Bangalore
Level 2	Prakash Tekethotil	prakash.tekethotil@iciciprupension.com	9825026807	Mumbai

Professionals are requested to contact Level 1 team members as their first point of contact and leverage Level 2 team members for any escalations.

Annexure 1: NPS Charges

The charges associated with NPS are regulated by the Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (PFRDA). These charges are exclusive of applicable taxes and are subject to revisions by PFRDA.

Below is the table outlining the various service charges levied by different NPS intermediaries:

NPS Intermediary	Charge head	Service Charges in INR	Mode of Deduction
POP	Common POP Charge (AUM Based)	0.20% per annum of Assets Under Management (AUM), subject to minimum of Rs 30 per quarter	Through your contributions
CRA	Account opening charges (One Time)	Rs 39.36	Through your contributions
	Annual account maintenance charges	Rs 57.63	
	Charge per transaction	Rs 3.36	
Pension Fund	Investment Management Fee	0.09% per annum	Through your contributions
Custodian	Asset Servicing charges	0.000000001770% per annum of assets in custody	
NPS Trust	Reimbursement of Expenses	0.003% per annum of asset managed	
Trustee Bank	NIL	NIL	--

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*As used in this document, "Deloitte USI" means Deloitte & Touche Assurance & Enterprise Risk Services India Private Limited, Deloitte Consulting India Private Limited, Deloitte Financial Advisory Services India Private Limited, Deloitte Tax Services India Private Limited, Deloitte Support Services India Private Limited, Deloitte Special Projects India Private Limited, Hashedin Technologies Private Limited and Deloitte Consulting India Digital Services Private Limited, Edge24 Business Process Services Limited Liability Partnership.

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